

Christian Z. Pratt, Ph.D.

Curriculum Vitae

Email pratt@ucsb.edu
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Publications [Google Scholar](#)

Research positions

- 2026 — Postdoctoral researcher at [UC Santa Barbara](#) with [Dr. Kerem Çamsarı](#) at the [Orchestrating Physics for Unconventional Systems \(OPUS\) Lab](#) in the [Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering](#) and the [Institute for Energy Efficiency](#).
Investigating the co-design of novel algorithms for machine learning and their implementations in energy-efficient probabilistic computers.
- 2022 – 2026 Graduate student researcher at [UC Davis](#) with [Dr. James P. Crutchfield](#) in the [Complexity Sciences Center](#) and the [Department of Physics and Astronomy](#).
Investigated the fundamental physics of computing with dynamical systems theory, stochastic thermodynamics, and superconducting circuit theory. Applications include developing energy-efficient superconducting computers.
- 2019 – 2021 Undergraduate researcher at UC Davis working with Dr. Michael Mulhearn in the Department of Physics and Astronomy.
Re-purposed smartphone camera sensors for detecting cosmic ray muons in table top experiments.

Education

- 2026 Ph.D. Physics, UC Davis
— Research advisor: Prof. James P. Crutchfield
— Thesis title: *Computing with Dynamical Energy Landscapes*
- 2022 M.Sc. Physics, UC Davis
- 2021 B.Sc. Physics, UC Davis
- 2019 A.A. Mathematics, San Diego Community College District

Publications

Peer reviewed

- 2025 C. Z. Pratt, K. J. Ray, and J. P. Crutchfield. Controlled erasure as a building block for universal thermodynamically-robust superconducting computing. *Chaos: An Interdisciplinary Journal for Nonlinear Science*. [10.1063/5.0227130](https://doi.org/10.1063/5.0227130)
- 2025 C. Z. Pratt, K. J. Ray, and J. P. Crutchfield. Extracting equations of motion from superconducting circuits. *Physical Review Research*. [10.1103/PhysRevResearch.7.013014](https://doi.org/10.1103/PhysRevResearch.7.013014)

Under review

- 2026 C. Z. Pratt, K. J. Ray, and J. P. Crutchfield. Metastable Dynamical Computing with Energy Landscapes: A Primer. [arXiv:2602.11390](https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.11390)

In prep

C. Z. Pratt, K. J. Ray and J. P. Crutchfield. Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits.

Presentations

Invited talks

- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: Remote seminar for the [Quantum Nanostructures and Nanofabrication \(QNN\) Group](#) at MIT.
- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: Remote seminar for the [Orchestrating Physics for Unconventional Systems \(OPUS\) Lab](#) at UC Santa Barbara.
- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: Remote seminar for the [Alternative Computing Group](#) at National Institute for Standards and Technology (NIST).
- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: Remote seminar for the [Türeci group](#) at Princeton University.

- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: Remote postdoc job talk for the [NanoComputing Research Lab](#) at Eindhoven University of Technology.
- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: Remote postdoc job talk for the [Takeuchi group](#) at Kobe University.
- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: Remote postdoc job talk for the [Yang group](#) at National University of Singapore.
- 2025 *Controlled Erasure as a Building Block for Universal Thermodynamically-Robust Superconducting Computing*: In-person seminar at the [Information Engines at the Frontiers of Nanoscale Thermodynamics workshop](#) in Telluride, Colorado.
- 2025 *Controlled Erasure as a Building Block for Universal Thermodynamically-Robust Superconducting Computing*: In-person seminar at the [Molecular Foundry](#) at LBNL.
- 2025 *Computing with Dynamical Energy Landscapes*: Poster presentation at the Interdisciplinary Graduate Research Exhibition at UC Davis.
- 2023 *Universal Dynamical Computing on the Nanoscale*: In-person seminar at the [Information Engines at the Frontiers of Nanoscale Thermodynamics workshop](#) in Telluride, Colorado.

Contributed talks

- 2026 *Comparing Langevin and SPICE Simulations of Dynamical Landscape Computing with Superconducting Circuits*: In-person guest seminar for the [Redwood Center](#) at UC Berkeley.
- 2025 *Controlled Erasure as a Building Block for Universal Thermodynamically-Robust Superconducting Computing*: 15 minute talk at Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics (SIAM) Conference on Applications of Dynamical Systems (DS25) in Denver, Colorado.
- 2025 *Controlled Erasure as a Building Block for Universal Thermodynamically-Robust Superconducting Computing*: 15 minute talk at APS March Meeting 2025 in Anaheim, California.
- 2024 *Controlled Erasure as a Building Block for Universal Thermodynamically-Robust Superconducting Computing*: [Recorded technical seminar](#) at the [Complexity Sciences Center \(CSC\)](#) at UC Davis.
- 2024 *Universal Dynamical Computing on the Nanoscale*: 15 minute talk at Dynamic Days 2024 in Davis, California.

2023 *Universal Dynamical Computing on the Nanoscale*: 15 minute talk for a Army Research Office on-site visit at the [Complexity Sciences Center \(CSC\)](#) at UC Davis.

Teaching

2026 9A: Classical mechanics

2025 256A: Physics of Information
256B: Physics of Computation

2021 - 2022 7B: Fluid mechanics, electrical circuits, Newtonian mechanics
7C: Modern physics, waves, optics
9A: Classical mechanics

Awards & Honors

2025 Ryan Couch Memorial Travel Award
Department of Physics and Astronomy
University of California, Davis

Fall 2025,
Winter 2025,
Spring 2024,
Spring 2023 Graduate Student Researcher Fellowship
Department of Physics and Astronomy
University of California, Davis

2018 NASA Community College Aerospace Scholar

2016 - 2019 Dean's Honors List
San Diego Community College District

Service and Outreach

2025 Workshop Volunteer Organizer. *Physics of Agency*. Beyond Institute for Theoretical Science (BITS). Pioneer, California.

2025 Session Chair for CS28: Electronic, Optical, and Condensed Matter Systems. *Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics (SIAM) Conference on Applications of Dynamical Systems (DS25)*. Denver, Colorado.

2020 - 2021	Mentor, Support Encourage and Develop For Children (SendForC)
2018	Volunteer, New Story Charity
2017 - 2018	Volunteer, San Diego Rescue Mission
2016 - 2018	Volunteer, San Diego Air and Space Museum

Last updated: May 15, 2026